



« Auxiliary gun
Unlike the cannon in the prow, the small breech-loading guns on either side of the galley could swivel. They would be loaded with small shot and used as anti-personnel weapons against the crew on the deck of an enemy galley.

« The binding of the oars
The oars are made of beechwood and 37 ft (11.4 m) long. Oars were sometimes made from a single piece of wood, but these broke easily and more often they were made of two lengths bound together.



« Renaissance rowlock
This peg, known as a thole pin, was the point at which the oar pivoted as the oarsmen drove the blade into the water. The oar was simply tied to the pin with a loop of rope.

BELOW DECKS

THE GALERA REAL had a wider and deeper hold than ordinary war galleys, and although there was not much headroom, there was plenty of space for stores. Below the poop deck were the armories and the majordomo's pantry, where food and drink were prepared for Don John and his advisers and officers. Foreward of this were storerooms for bread and fresh vegetables, which would be taken on board whenever possible. Then there were the basic stores of water, wine, and grain for the oarsmen. More or less amidships was the gunpowder room and beneath the mainmast an extensive area given over to spare sailcloth, spars, and ropes. At the front of the hold was the surgeon's dispensary and a cramped surgery where he could set the bones or amputate the limbs of the wounded.



» Rowing bench and oar
The most experienced and trusted oarsman took the position on the inside, from where he dictated the timing of the stroke to the other three oarsmen, who were normally less skilled. These each grasped one of the three handhold battens.



» Range on the deck
One of the luxury extras on Don John's galley was a fire for cooking. On the replica of the *Galera Real* one of the oarsman's benches on the port side has been removed and the space created used for a fire with a metal bar above it for suspending cooking pots. This leaves the ship with 30 oars on one side and only 29 on the other.



« Stores in the hold
Besides food, the spacious hold contained spare clothing, armor, and weapons. This recreated scene includes a selection of rapiers and a lockable chest of the kind that would have been used by the gentlemen on Don John's staff.



» Basic stores
The hold contained sacks of grain and barrels of wine and water. The oarsmen were fed on simple gruel and given wine and water to drink. When fighting in the heat of summer, it was essential to keep the crew well watered.



» Essential gear
Buckets were in constant use on the galley: for carrying food and water, for washing the filth from the decks and the oarsmen's benches, and on occasions for putting out fires during battle.